



AETHERIAL PURITY

No Man's Sky
Modlist & Guide

Version 6.45.1 · 2026

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Installation Guide

Game Prep

This guide targets **No Man's Sky** version **6.45.1** on **Steam**. Before anything else, install the game from Steam and let it finish its first-time setup.

1. Install **No Man's Sky** from the Steam store and let it download completely.
2. Launch the game once, all the way to the main menu, so the game generates its files and folders.
3. On the main menu, confirm the version line reads **6.45.1**. This is the version the entire guide — and every mod you add to it — is written against.

Note: Version numbers change whenever the game updates. Every time No Man's Sky downloads an update, re-check the main menu and confirm it still reads 6.45.1. If it does not, treat the mods in this guide as unverified until you re-check their dates (see Version Compatibility below).

Tip: Mods for No Man's Sky are folder-based patches since the **Worlds Part II** rework: each mod is a folder of .EXML/.MBIN patch files, and the game loads them from the MODS folder inside GAMEDATA: ... \No Man's Sky\GAMEDATA\MODS\. The old .pak-in-PCBANKS\MODS system is obsolete — files packed that way are ignored by modern builds. You will rarely touch this folder by hand, because the manager in this guide handles it for you — but knowing where mods live makes every troubleshooting step below understandable.

Singularity — the Mod Manager

The organizer for this modlist is **Singularity**, an open-source, lightweight Windows mod manager built specifically for No Man's Sky (Tauri v2, GPL-3.0) by the developer Syzzle07 — github.com/Syzzle07/SingularityMM.

Its advertised feature set, straight from the project page:

1. **Automatic game detection** — finds your Steam, GOG, or Game Pass PC installation of No Man's Sky.
2. **Mod management** — enable, disable, download, install, and set the priority of your mods.
3. **Mod update check** — check for updates to your installed mods.
4. **Drag & drop installation** — install mods by dropping .zip, .rar, or .7z files onto the window.
5. **Nexus Mods integration with SSO** — link your Nexus account and download with the “Mod Manager Download” button; Premium accounts can also browse and download inside the manager.
6. **Profiles** — save named mod profiles for different play styles.

The project is distributed through GitHub Releases. The latest release at the time of writing is **v2.2.8** (2026-02-15) — github.com/Syzzle07/SingularityMM/releases.

Note: Facts about Singularity in this chapter (features, versions, release dates) come from the project's GitHub page and release notes, verified 2026-08-05. If you ever see a newer release, prefer it — the steps below do not change.

Installing Singularity

1. Open the releases page linked above and download the latest **setup** installer (Singularity_<version>_x64-setup.exe). A portable .exe is also offered if you prefer not to install.
2. Run the setup and follow the prompts. Install to any location you like — it does not need to live next to the game.

3. The only runtime dependency is **WebView2**, which ships with updated Windows 10 and Windows 11. If the app refuses to start, install WebView2 from [the Microsoft WebView2 page](#) and retry.
4. Launch Singularity.

Tip: Prefer the installer over the portable build for a first-time setup: it registers the app normally and gives you Start-menu access. The portable build is a good fallback if you want the manager on a USB stick or another drive.

First Launch & Game Detection

On first launch, Singularity scans for a No Man's Sky installation.

1. Confirm it detected your Steam copy. The detection covers Steam, GOG, and Game Pass PC installs automatically.
2. If detection fails, point it at your install manually: find the folder that contains GAMEDATA — for a default Steam install that is `...\\Steam\\steamapps\\common\\No Man's Sky\\`.
3. Confirm the mods folder the manager reports: it should resolve to `...\\No Man's Sky\\GAMEDATA\\MODS\\`.

Warning: The mods folder must be the one **inside** GAMEDATA. Dropping mods into PCBANKS\\MODS (the pre-Worlds-II location) does nothing on modern builds. If you are not sure where Steam put the game, right-click **No Man's Sky** in your Steam library → **Manage** → **Browse local files**.

Note: Modern No Man's Sky manages mod loading through GCMODSETTINGS.MXML in `...\\No Man's Sky\\Binaries\\SETTINGS\\`. If mods load as vanilla, this file is the first thing to check: it may contain `DisableAllMods = true` (the game can set this itself after a crash). The file is safe to delete — the game regenerates it on next launch. The old `enablemods.txt` switch from the PCBANKS era is no longer part of the flow; ignore guides that still mention it.

The Aetherial Purity Profile

Each wave of this guide is its own new game with its own mod subset, and Singularity's **Profiles** feature is exactly what maps to that structure.

1. Create a profile and name it **Aetherial Purity**.
2. Decide on your per-wave organisation: either one profile per wave (0, 1, 2) or a single profile that you switch by enabling/disabling mods. Either works; the per-wave switching section below assumes you can tell at a glance which mods belong to which wave, so pick whichever you can keep tidy.
3. Wave 0 carries the quality-of-life base that stays active throughout. Content mods stay scoped per wave and are only enabled when that wave's design calls for them.

Installing Mods

Every mod in this guide is listed as a **mod card** in its wave's Modlist section, and every card carries the mod's page URL. To bring a mod into Singularity, any of these works:

1. **Drag & drop** — download the mod as `.zip`, `.rar`, or `.7z` and drop the archive onto the Singularity window.
2. **Nexus Mods** — with your Nexus account linked (SSO), use the mod page's "Mod Manager Download" button; Singularity receives it directly. Premium users can also browse and download inside the manager.
3. **Manual** — download the archive yourself and add it through the app.

Note: In this release the mod cards are filled with a curated, verified modlist (see the wave chapters), except for a few slots that remain “**user to provide**” because no maintained mod fits the wave rules — those are listed in STATUS.md. The installation flow above is all it takes to bring any card’s mod in.

Managing Mods

1. **Enable / disable** — the per-mod toggle is how wave switching works. A disabled mod is not loaded by the game.
2. **Update check** — after every game update, run the update check. It tells you which installed mods have newer versions; a mod built for an older game build is the most common breakage.
3. **Priority** — see Load Order below.

Load Order & Priorities

When two mods change the same game file, only one result can win. Singularity’s **priority** ordering decides which: higher priority wins for overlapping content.

1. Mods that are independent of each other do not care about order.
2. Mods that both touch the same system **do** — check each mod card’s Notes for any stated order requirement, and record what you find in `conflicts-mods.md` (that file is deliberately kept out of the PDF so you can maintain it freely).
3. When in doubt, start a new game and confirm the two mods’ effects both appear as their pages describe.

Warning: Do not stack mods that edit the same feature “to see what happens.” The result is usually the losing mod silently doing nothing, or a broken save-shaped surprise. One mod per feature, and let priority resolve the rare overlap.

Backup & Restore

1. **Saves** — No Man’s Sky keeps its saves under `%APPDATA%\HelloGames\NMS\` on Windows, and Steam Cloud syncs them. Before switching waves or updating several mods at once, copy that folder aside.
2. **Mod set** — Singularity manages the installed mods themselves. If you ever want to rebuild the list from scratch, the mod cards in this guide are the record: each card’s URL is enough to re-install everything.

Version Compatibility

This guide is written for version **6.45.1**, and every mod in it must be compatible with that version. The heuristic for judging compatibility, when a specific mod version is unknown, is the **patch / release date**:

1. A mod whose page shows it was updated close to the release of 6.45.1 is the safest bet — it was most recently checked against the current game.
2. A mod that has not been touched in months may still work fine, but it is riskier.
3. Dependencies matter as much as dates: a mod that requires something you do not have is incompatible no matter how fresh it is.

Note: There is a hard floor, not just a heuristic: the **Worlds Part II** rework (late January 2025) changed how mods are packaged, and the modding community’s rule of thumb is that no mod last updated before 29 January 2025 works with modern game builds. Every card in this guide’s

waves was verified to be updated after that date on 2026-08-12; the “**user to provide**” slots are exactly the ones where no maintained mod could be found.

Tip: Read each mod’s own page before adding it — the page’s last-updated date and listed requirements are the signals to trust, not titles or badges elsewhere. And whenever the game updates, re-run the update check and re-read the affected mod pages: a new game build can break mods that were fine the day before.

Launch & Verify

1. Start the game from Steam.
2. Check the main menu version line reads 6.45.1.
3. Start a **new** game for the wave you intend to play.
4. Play the opening stretch and confirm the mods behave the way the wave guide describes — No Man’s Sky has no in-game mod list, so in-game behavior is the ground truth.

Tip: Do not trust a mod list from memory. Singularity’s mod list is the authoritative view of what is enabled — one glance before each session tells you the wave is set up right.

Per-Wave Switching

Each wave is its own new game with its own mod subset. Switching is a menu chore, not a reinstall:

1. Open Singularity and switch to the profile (or mod subset) for the next wave.
2. Enable that wave’s mods and disable the previous wave’s content mods. Wave 0’s UI/QoL base stays on throughout.
3. Start a new game for the wave.

Warning: The wrong mods break the wave design. If content mods from one wave are carried into a wave that should not have them, the intended progression is lost and the game plays differently than the guide describes. Review the enabled list before starting each new game.

Tip: Because profiles remember the exact set and priorities of mods, switching waves never requires uninstalling anything. The profile or the enable/disable list is the entire workflow.

Waves & New-Game Setups

Wave 0: First Light

How to Play

This chapter is the complete beginner tutorial for Wave 0. It assumes you have never played No Man's Sky and have **no mods active yet** — just the vanilla game at version 6.45.1. Wave 0 exists to teach the game; the mods you add to it only make the game easier to see, operate, and plan.

The Story So Far

First Light. The star you were chasing has burned out — or so you thought. Where its light should have ended, you found a glimmer instead: a thread of pale fire stretched between dead worlds, humming with a frequency your suit has started to translate into names you do not remember choosing. Your ship is down. Your memories begin at the impact. Somewhere ahead, a light is waiting to be found, and every star chart you will ever draw starts from this one waking moment. This is your first day in the universe, and the universe is enormous.

Your First Moments

You wake beside a wrecked starship on an alien world. The game teaches as you go — this section tells you what the prompts mean.

1. **Move and look** — standard first-person controls; your keybinds are shown on screen and rebindable in **Options**. Press the jetpack key (Space by default) to boost, and hold it to glide. Watch your fuel — you can see the jetpack meter while airborne.
2. **Scan** — the scan key (C by default) pulses your surroundings and reveals nearby resources and points of interest. Scan often; scanning is how you **see**.
3. **Analysis visor** — the visor key (F by default) zooms into a detailed view: it names the flora and fauna around you, highlights resource deposits, and marks where to go next.
4. **Mining beam** — hold the fire button on rocks, plants, and crystals to harvest them. Resources stream into your inventory automatically. Rocks give ferrite, plants give carbon, glowing plants and hazards give oxygen.
5. **Interact** — the interact key (E by default) opens doors, picks things up, talks to terminals, and enters your ship.

Tip: The two meters that matter at the very start are **life support** and **hazard protection**, both bottom-right on your HUD. Life support drains slowly no matter what and is refilled with **oxygen**. Hazard protection drains on hostile worlds and is refilled with **sodium** (the yellow glowing plants). Refill either from the quick menu (X by default). If either runs dry, your **health** starts draining instead — that is the panic state you want to avoid.

The Survival Loop

Every early session is the same loop, in different clothes: **gather** → **refuel** → **survive** → **repair** → **fly**.

1. **Carbon** — from plants. Fuel for your mining beam's overheat recovery, refining, and early crafting. Never leave base without a stack.
2. **Ferrite dust** — from rocks. The backbone of repairs and base building.
3. **Oxygen** — from plants, oxygen-rich hazards, and some crystals. Life support fuel and a refining ingredient.
4. **Sodium** — from yellow plants on most worlds. Hazard protection fuel; on extreme worlds, carry a lot.

Your two meters are the clock: when they dip, top them up **before** they empty. Dying is recoverable (you respawn at your ship or last save point), but it costs you your current loot run, so treat the meters as the tutorial's way of teaching you to prepare.

Tip: Save often: exiting your ship saves, and so do save points and beacons. Early on, the habit of “get out of the ship = save” will save you more than any mod ever will.

First Flight

The early missions walk you through repairing your ship. The two repairs that matter first:

1. **Launch thrusters** — takeoff fuel. Craft **Launch Fuel** (40 **Di-hydrogen** + 1 **Metal Plating**) and refuel from the ship's inventory screen. Di-hydrogen comes from the blue crystals on most planets; metal plating is crafted from ferrite.
2. **Pulse engine** — the in-system drive that makes travel between planets fast. Hold the boost key once airborne and you streak across the sky; release when you reach the planet you want.

Takeoff is automatic once your thrusters are fuelled — the ship lifts when you boost from the ground. Landing is manual or auto: aim at a landing pad, or let the game set you down on clear ground.

Tip: The moment you can fly, the **quick menu** (X by default) becomes your best friend: it holds summoning (your ship, later exocraft), refuelling shortcuts, and the camera. Learn it early.

The Core Quest Lines

Your **mission log** (Esc → Mission Log) tracks everything. There are three story threads to know at the beginner level:

1. **Awakenings** — the tutorial line. It takes you from the wrecked ship to your first space station and unlocks the fundamentals. Follow it until it ends; it is your onboarding.
2. **The Atlas Path** — the philosophical main line about the universe's makers. It hands out blueprints and lore; you can pursue it whenever you want.
3. **The Artemis Path** — the long-form story that begins after you have made a few hyperdrive jumps. This is the “real” campaign for most players.

Note: The **Anomaly** — the circular hub you can summon from the quick menu — is the multiplayer and endgame hub: the Nexus mission board, quicksilver shop, and the base-building specialists live there. You unlock the ability to summon it early in the story; once it is available, use it.

Base Building Basics

Your first base is your home port, and it can be small.

1. **Base computer** — claim a spot by building the computer and using it. From then on the area is yours.
2. **Power** — **solar panels** plus **batteries** are the reliable pair (day/night cycle); the **biofuel reactor** is the early stopgap. Nothing important runs without power, so build power first.
3. **Teleporter** — build one at your base; it links to the space stations you visit. This is your fast-travel network.
4. **Refiner** — turns raw resources into better ones (carbon → condensed carbon, ferrite → pure ferrite, and so on). It is the gateway to advanced crafting.
5. **Save point** — one small structure that saves on demand. Build one beside your door.

Tip: Your first base does not need to be pretty — it needs to be **useful**: power, a refiner, a teleporter, a save point. You can build your dream base later, somewhere beautiful.

Crafting & Inventory

1. **Units** — the everyday currency. Earned by selling surplus resources and discoveries; spent on ships, upgrades, and supplies.
2. **Nanites** — the upgrade currency. Earned from scanning discoveries, missions, and some interactions; spent on technology and upgrade modules.
3. **Quicksilver** — the special currency of the Anomaly. Earned from Nexus missions and expeditions; spent on cosmetic and exotic items.

Your inventory has four homes: **exosuit**, **ship**, **multi-tool**, **freighter** (the freighter comes later). Expand the exosuit early — one extra slot per space station (costs units), and free slots from **drop pods** found by scanning planets.

Tip: Refining is where the real value is. Carbon → **condensed carbon** doubles its usefulness; ferrite → **pure ferrite** unlocks better building. Get comfortable with the refiner in Wave 0 and the later waves' economy will feel natural.

New-Game Checklist

1. Confirm the main menu reads version 6.45.1.
2. Confirm Singularity has exactly Wave 0's mods enabled — and nothing else.
3. Start a **new** game on the difficulty you want (Normal is the intended Wave 0 experience).
4. Follow **Awakenings** to the space station.
5. Claim your first base; build power, refiner, teleporter, save point.
6. Save by getting out of your ship, often.
7. When the story prompts you to jump star systems, that is Wave 1's door — close it for now and enjoy learning to fly.

Wave 0: Modlist

Wave 0 adds no gameplay content. Every mod in this chapter exists for one of three reasons: to make the game easier to **see**, easier to **operate**, or easier to **plan**. Nothing here changes a resource, a recipe, a ship stat, or a reward table — that is the wave's hard rule. Wave 0 admits only **UI and quality-of-life** mods: interfaces, readability, information display, and minor conveniences that do not touch the game's numbers.

The cards below are the curated Wave 0 set, verified against the game version this guide targets: every mod was checked on Nexus Mods on 2026-08-12 and is listed with the date its page last updated, so the compatibility heuristic from the installation chapter can be applied at a glance. The mods split across the next two sections by what they change: **Mechanics** for tools that change how you work with the game, and **Graphics** for mods that change how the game looks and how it tells you what is happening.

Mechanics (UI & Quality-of-Life)

Tools that make the game easier to operate and plan — inventory conveniences, HUD information, navigation aids — without changing any game value.

Fast Actions

Dependencies: None

Impact: Speeds up or removes the hold-to-confirm delay on menu selection, crafting and dismantling, resource transfers to/from your ship, entering your ship, NPC dialogue, gathering small plants, launching refinery processing, and recovering deployable tech. Purely removes waiting — no game values change.

Notes: by Lo2k, v7.1, updated 2026-02-23. Ships two versions: instant (almost no delay) and fast (between original and instant); pick one. A classic Wave 0 pick: it only removes time.

Instant Text Display

Dependencies: None

Impact: Shows dialogue and terminal text instantly instead of the default typewriter crawl; holding the interact key skips even faster. Reading-speed QoL only.

Notes: by NooBzPoWaH, v6.20, updated 2026-02-12; page states compatibility with game 6.44 (The Swarm). Full-file replacement of the punctuation-delay table, so it does not merge — do not stack with another mod editing that file.

Graphics (Visual & Interface)

Mods that only change how the game looks: colors, textures, HUD styling, readability. Nothing here changes behavior.

No Black Bars

Dependencies: None

Impact: Removes the cinematic black bars that appear on the top and bottom of the screen when landing on a planet, reaching a milestone, activating a monolith, or meeting an alien. Pure presentation.

Notes: by Lo2k, v3.7, updated 2026-04-12 (game 6.32). Cannot run alongside another mod editing the HUD bars or cinematic-bars files; an AMUMSS Lua script is included for merging if you ever stack one.

Unified Warps

Dependencies: None

Impact: Unifies black-hole, portal, ship, and teleporter warp visuals into one calmer, darker effect and repositions the warp camera. Reduces flashing and visual overload during transitions.

Notes: by Silent369, v5.5, updated 2026-06-23 — the page states it is updated for game 6.45.1, exactly this guide's target version. Four visual variants; install exactly one.

Wave 0: Mechanics

Wave 0's mechanics chapter explains the systems a beginner actually interacts with, and where UI/QoL mods are allowed to help without breaking the wave's rule. If a tool tells you more about the game, that is allowed. If it changes what the game **is**, it belongs to a later wave.

Survival & Inventory

The survival loop lives on two meters and four inventories. Beginner mechanics to understand: life support (oxygen), hazard protection (sodium), and the fact that inventory space, not money, is your real early-game resource.

This is the most common home for Wave 0 mods: inventory conveniences, stack-size clarity, and survival-meter readability are all “easier to operate” — allowed here, as long as nothing changes the rates the game uses.

Better Ship Transfer Ranges

Dependencies: None

Impact: Raises the distance at which you can transfer items to your ship from 50 m to 200 m (and the teleport-module transfer from 100 m to 400 m), so the game stops telling you the ship is out of reach while you are mid-inventory. A convenience distance, not a rate change.

Notes: by Lo2k, v6.0, updated 2025-10-06. Two small files (ship range + teleport module range); both are safe to install together.

Scanning & Navigation

Scanning and the analysis visor are how you see the world: flora and fauna discovery, resource deposits, points of interest. The mission log and galaxy map are your navigation.

Mods that make discovery data clearer or navigation easier to read fit here. Mods that reveal things the game hides (such as exact planet resource surveys) are a judgement call: if the information is something the game shows you anyway, reformatted, it is allowed; if it is information the game withholds, it changes the planning challenge and belongs to a later wave.

Faster Scanning

Dependencies: None

Impact: Shortens the analysis-visor scan and its cooldown so tagging minerals, plants, fauna, and points of interest stops interrupting you. Scan timing is an animation delay, not a game value — nothing you scan changes.

Notes: by Flugelwulff, v6.45, updated for game 6.45 — matches this guide's target version. Pick one speed variant; the instant option is the most aggressive.

Exact Markers

Dependencies: None

Impact: Restores the old marker behaviour where waypoint icons sit exactly on top of the resource or building they mark, instead of floating far above it. Makes tagged targets easier to find and track — readability only.

Notes: by Lo2k, v2.4, updated 2025-01-29 (Worlds Part II modding scheme).

Ship & Exosuit QoL

Your ship and exosuit are your body in this universe. Beginner-relevant QoL: refuelling reminders, inventory transfer shortcuts, launch-thruster visibility.

Wave 0 mods here may only make these interactions clearer — never cheaper, faster, or stronger. A reminder that your launch fuel is low is allowed; a mod that makes launch fuel last longer is not (that is a numbers change).

Better Pulse Drive Aim

Dependencies: None

Impact: Shrinks the invisible target zones the pulse drive locks onto, so your ship only engages pulse toward something you are genuinely pointing at — no more yanking you toward a random building when you meant to skim the rings. Control QoL, no speed or fuel changes.

Notes: by Andarius, maintained by Lo2k (v2.3, updated 2025-01-31, Worlds Part II scheme). If you later add a mod that edits the same ship-globals file, merge via the author's AMUMSS article.

Wave o: Graphics

No Man's Sky is a game about looking at beautiful places, so graphics matter twice: once for beauty, once for readability. Wave o graphics mods may change **how the game looks** — never what it does.

Visual Settings

Before any graphics mod, tune the vanilla settings: resolution and framerate target first, then the heavy hitters (shadow quality, terrain tessellation, post-processing). If your machine offers upscaling (DLSS/FSR/XeSS where the game exposes it), enabling it is usually a bigger win than any mod. Turn **motion blur** off if it bothers you; keep **FOV** somewhere you can scan comfortably.

Tip: Set the game up for a stable framerate **before** adding graphics mods. A mod layered on a stuttery base just moves the problem around — and the wave's rule means a graphics mod is only ever allowed to change appearance, not to fix a performance issue by removing game content.

HUD & Interface

The HUD is your cockpit: health, hazard protection, life support, waypoints, and the quick menu. Readability mods (larger text, clearer icons, less clutter) are the classic Wave o graphics additions — they make the game easier to **see**, which is exactly this wave's purpose.

Hide or Fade Notifications

Dependencies: None

Impact: Hides the notification panel entirely, or fades its text into the background (your choice of two files): guidance hints, extreme-weather warnings, mission remarks, and frigate captain chatter stop cluttering the view. Gameplay is untouched — you just stop being nudged.

Notes: by lMonk, v1.77, updated 2026-04-08 (game 6.30). Install exactly one of the two included folders; modifies the HUD notification panel file, so do not stack with another mod editing it.

Visual Polish

Color grading, sky and lighting tweaks, texture packs — appearance-only changes. The line to hold: if a mod changes a game value to achieve its look, it is no longer graphics-only and must wait for a later wave.

HD Space Planet Clouds

Dependencies: None

Impact: Replaces the long-distance planet clouds you see from space with a high-resolution 8K texture, removing tiling seams, holes, and speckle artifacts. Only the space view changes — ground-level volumetric clouds are untouched.

Notes: by Lo2k, v2.2, updated 2026-02-12 (game 6.21). Optional companion: Rotating Atmosphere (mod 1662) — see conflicts-mods.md before pairing.

Exosolar's and Babs' Expanse

Dependencies: None

Impact: Overhauls space background and star/nebula colouring with 768 combinations so solar systems stop looking alike; a Black Edition strips nebulae for a stark void. Appearance only — it never touches what space does.

Notes: by Exosolar and Babscoole, v6.42, updated 2026-05-29. Install one palette set; the vanilla palette is included if you want to sample first.

Natural Nights

Dependencies: None

Impact: Makes nights realistically dark: no overbright blue tint, no flashy night-time water foam, and your torch becomes useful again. Light and colour only — nothing about the day/night cycle's gameplay changes.

Notes: by Degraaaff, maintained by Lo2k, v3.0, updated 2025-08-30 (game 6.01). Incompatible with any other mod editing the night-sky colour file; pairs naturally with Better Torch Light below.

Better Torch Light

Dependencies: None

Impact: Changes the torch from a flat wall of light into a proper light cone for better first-person immersion — especially welcome with Natural Nights making the dark actually dark.

Notes: by Lo2k, v5.3, updated 2025-06-02. Edits the gameplay-globals file: cannot run alongside another mod touching it unless merged via the included AMUMSS Lua script.

Fine LOD

Dependencies: None

Impact: Loads high-detail models and textures from farther away and reduces the spawn delay of rocks and flora around you, cutting pop-in. Appearance and smoothness only; the page notes a small framerate cost.

Notes: by Prof Horatio Hafnaugels, v5.58, updated 2025-03-10; the page states it targets Worlds II and beyond but has not been touched since — check the compatibility checker (mod 880) after any game update. Use the Classic file with ultra planet quality for the full 3x effect, or Lite for the gentler 2x. Conflicts with mods editing the graphics-globals or environment-globals files.

Wave 1: The Cartographer

Wave 1: Strategy

The Story So Far

The Cartographer. You have learned to survive, and now the map is open. The thread of pale fire that woke you has grown into a web of routes: economy charts, freighter lanes, fleet schedules. You are no longer a survivor clinging to one world — you are the one who draws the lines between worlds, who knows which star pays for fuel and which planet hides the rare harvest. Wave 1 is where the universe stops being a backdrop and becomes a market, a fleet, a project.

This wave is a **new game**, harder than Wave 0: more systems live, the economy matters, and your choices compound.

The Cartographer's Economy

1. **Understand economies** — every star system has an economy type and a wealth level. Prices vary by system, and **trade routes** — buying in systems that produce cheap goods and selling where they are scarce — are the classic income engine. The space station's trade terminal and the galaxy map's economy filter are your tools.
2. **Buy low, sell high** — watch the market: goods sell for more in systems whose economy **consumes** them. A system map that lists economies (if you have the economy scanner) turns the whole region into a route.
3. **Craft for profit** — refining and crafting can turn cheap inputs into pricier products. The value-add loop is where the “no power spikes” philosophy lives on your side of the screen: the game's economy is the challenge, not the mods.
4. **Nanites as a second wallet** — nanites fund upgrades. Earn them by uploading scanned discoveries, completing missions, and interacting with the right NPCs. Never spend nanites on something you can buy with units.

Tip: The single most useful Wave 1 purchase is the **economy scanner** for your starship (from space stations). It turns the galaxy map from decoration into a price list.

Exploration & Discovery

1. **Scan everything, upload everything** — every creature, plant, and mineral you scan and upload pays. Completed planet surveys pay a bonus. This is steady, risk-free income that funds everything else.
2. **Chase the rare harvest** — planets with rare or exotic resources (activated metals, storm crystals, curious deposits) are where the real money is — and where the risk is: storms, sentinels, and harsh hazards.
3. **Mark what matters** — base locations, portal addresses, and good mining spots are your cartographer's notes. The game's waypoints and your own bases do this; keep your bookkeeping tidy.

Frigates & the Fleet

1. **The freighter is your mobile base** — claim a freighter when the game offers it (or buy one), and it becomes your command post: storage, fleet management, and a warp-capable home.
2. **Frigates run missions** — buy frigates, send them on expeditions from the fleet management console. They bring back units, resources, and rare finds. Frigate class and specialization matter; a balanced fleet covers more mission types.

3. **Fleet upkeep** — fuel the expeditions, repair damaged frigates, and level your frigates up through successful missions. A working fleet is a compounding asset — which is exactly why Wave 1 mods may deepen it but never inflate it.

Upgrade Priorities

1. **Exosuit first** — more inventory, more tech slots, movement upgrades (jetpack range and fuel). The suit is the platform every other upgrade stands on.
2. **Multi-tool** — one good multi-tool beats three average ones. Upgrade the mining beam and scanner first; combat is secondary at this stage.
3. **Starship** — class matters ($C \rightarrow B \rightarrow A \rightarrow S$), and **S-class** is the prize. An A-class with good tech is worth more than a bare S-class; hunt upgrades, not just hulls.
4. **Tech modules** — purchased with nanites, installed in tech slots. Stacked modules of the same type boost each other; this is the real power curve, and it is the game's, not a mod's.

Tip: The Wave 1 power curve is **supposed** to come from the game: better ships, stacked modules, a growing fleet. If a mod proposal for this wave would skip any of that, it fails the wave's "no pure power spikes" rule — new systems yes, shortcuts no.

The Harder New Game

Wave 1 is a fresh save on a harder setting. The intended shape:

1. Start a new game — **Survival** (harsher hazards, scarcer resources) is the intended Wave 1 difficulty; **Permadeath** is the natural Wave 2 test.
2. Keep Wave 0's UI/QoL base enabled — it is difficulty-agnostic.
3. Enable Wave 1's content and mechanics mods only.
4. Play the economy and fleet loops deliberately: set an income target per session, not a grind.

Warning: A Wave 1 new game must not carry Wave 2's mods — the systems this wave teaches (economy, fleet) are the tutorial for Wave 2's depth. Check Singularity's enabled list before starting the save.

Wave 1: Modlist

Wave 1 opens the door to **content and new mechanics**. The wave's philosophy: mods may add systems, deepen existing ones, and open new decisions — but they may not hand out power. A mod that adds a new gameplay layer is welcome; a mod that makes you stronger, richer, or faster without adding a decision is a pure power spike and does not belong here.

The curation contract changed with this release (see STATUS.md): the cards below were selected and verified for Wave 1 on 2026-08-12 against the target game version, and every card carries its last-updated date so the compatibility heuristic applies at a glance. Sections that still show a "**user to provide**" card are slots where no maintained mod was found that fits the wave's rules — the project does not pad the list with power spikes or abandoned mods, so those stay open for you.

The cards split across two sections: **Mechanics** for mods that change or deepen how the game plays, and **Content** for mods that add new things to do.

Mechanics

Mods that deepen the systems Wave 1 is built on: the economy, exploration, fleet management, and upgrade paths. They must add decisions or information — never raw advantage.

Atmosphere Hover and Reverse - Pulse Speed Adjustments

Dependencies: None

Impact: Lets your starship hover at 0 u/s and reverse while in a planet's atmosphere, giving precise control for scouting and landing. Adds a control option — nothing gets faster, richer, or stronger.

Notes: by BigEx20 AKA Chromos, v6.11.0, updated 2025-10-24. Install exactly one option folder (hover, reverse, or both). Conflicts with any other mod editing GCSPACESHIPGLOBALS.GLOBAL — merge via the included Lua script if you ever add one. The optional pulse-speed presets change game numbers and are intentionally left off in this modlist.

Content

Mods that add new gameplay: new mechanics, new activities, new depth to existing loops. The bar is the same — a new system must make you **choose**, not just **win**.

Multi Biomes - Voyagers

Dependencies: None

Impact: Lets individual planets combine several of the game's biomes, so a single world can hold forest, desert, and tundra regions instead of one flat identity. Adds exploration decisions — where to land and what to seek — without touching rewards or rates.

Notes: by trevix, v3.0, updated 2025-08-28 (Voyagers era). The current maintained successor to the famous Better Planet Generation (which has not been updated since 2024 and is no longer compatible with modern game builds). Avoid stacking with other planet-generation mods.

Wave 1: Mechanics

The systems this wave deepens — and where content mods are welcome to add depth.

Multi-Tool & Upgrades

Your multi-tool is a Swiss-army starship: mining beam, scanner, and weaponry in one package. Wave 1 mechanics: module stacking (same-type modules boost each other), class hunting, and the trade-off between mining, scanning, and combat investments. Mods that add new technology or upgrade depth fit here; mods that multiply your damage or yield do not.

Note: This slot is open: as of 2026-08-12 no maintained mod was found that adds multi-tool upgrade depth without changing game numbers (candidates like mining-speed and tech-overload tweaks are either abandoned or edit values). See STATUS.md.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Starships & Classes

Ship classes C/B/A/S, tech vs cargo slots, and the upgrade economy. The Wave 1 story is chasing a better hull and stacking it with modules. A mechanics mod here might add new ship systems, customization depth, or class-relevant gameplay — never free performance.

Note: This slot is open: the maintained mods that touch ship classes either inflate generation odds (a pure power spike, excluded) or are abandoned. See STATUS.md for the evaluated list.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Exocraft & Ground Travel

Exocraft unlock through base-building quests and change how you explore a planet: mining vehicles, haulers, speeders. Wave 1 mechanics mods may add new vehicles or deepen the ground-travel loop.

Natural Steering

Dependencies: None

Impact: Uncouples mouse-look from exocraft steering so driving uses normal WASD-style controls while you can look around freely. Pure control QoL — no vehicle stat changes.

Notes: by Lo2k, v2.2, updated 2025-01-31 (Worlds Part II scheme). Enables a hidden in-game option rather than replacing files.

Base Automation

Mineral and gas extractors, supply chains, and the logistics of a working base. This is the bridge between Wave 1's economy and Wave 2's civilization systems. Mods that deepen automation — new machines, better routing decisions — are the wave's best fit; mods that make extractors free or infinite are power spikes.

Exosolar's and Babs' Beyond Base Building

Dependencies: None

Impact: Adds extreme freedom to vanilla base building: almost a thousand vanilla parts become scalable, recolorable, placeable above and below water, and buildable on freighters and planetary bases, with hard-coded limits (extractors, terminals, base computer) respected. Does not add new parts and does not touch extraction rates — the optional Lua rate multipliers are a power spike and stay off in this modlist.

Notes: by Exosolar, NeptuneX3, and Babscoole, v6.40, updated 2026-05-28 (game 6.40 Swarm). Fully Lua-scripted; use AMUMSS to merge with other base-building mods if you ever stack one. You still unlock blueprints the normal way.

Wave 1: Content

Content mods add **things to do**. The wave's rule: a new system must create decisions — where to go, what to build, what to prioritize — rather than handing out rewards.

The classic content shapes for this wave:

1. **New activities** — mechanics that give the mid-game new loops to engage with.
 2. **Deeper systems** — expanding an existing system (economy, exploration, fleet) with more moving parts.
 3. **New progression** — alternatives to the vanilla upgrade path that still cost effort.
- Each shape is welcome; each must be judged by the same question: does it make the player choose, or does it make the player win?

Auto Scanner Plus

Dependencies: None

Impact: Auto-scans a wide range of planetary structures and objects within a set distance — abandoned buildings, crashed ships and freighters, curious deposits, drop pods, factories, monoliths, ruins, sentinel hives, and more — so points of interest appear on the HUD from farther away, on foot or in flight. It surfaces information the game already has, which Wave 0's rules deliberately defer to a later wave: it changes how you plan a hunt, not what the hunt pays.

Notes: by Silent369, v5.4, updated 2026-06-23. Touches many entity files (a long list on the mod page); merge with AMUMSS if you stack mods that edit the same building files. Portals are listed in the mod but noted as not currently working.

Exosolar's and Babs' Deadzone III - Revenge of the Deadzone

Dependencies: None (designed to pair with Dead Wreckoning)

Impact: Gives dead planets real variety: some get one of five dusty aesthetics, some grow giant rock formations, some get something else entirely. Dead worlds stop being a grey afterthought and start being places you land on to see what you got.

Notes: by Exosolar and Babscoole, v6.42, updated 2026-05-29. Pairs with Dead Wreckoning below — together they turn dead planets into exploration destinations.

Exosolar's and Babs' Dead Wreckoning

Dependencies: None (designed to pair with Deadzone III)

Impact: Adds alien structures, ruins, debris, damaged machinery, crashed freighters, pilotless starships, traveler graves, and rare story constructs to dead planets — reasons to stop and search worlds that used to hold nothing. Adds discovery content without changing any economy.

Notes: by Exosolar and Babscoole, v6.42, updated 2026-05-29. The page states it does not change biome or biome-object files and is compatible with planet-generation mods.

Wave 1: Graphics

At Wave 1 the visual bar rises with the stakes: you are spending more time in space stations, fleet views, and dense UI screens. Graphics mods here may improve how the game presents itself — cleaner interfaces, better HUD information, refined visuals — without changing what the game does.

Better Colorful Planet Rings

Dependencies: None

Impact: Replaces the default pale planet rings with vivid colour palettes — turquoise bands, lilac halos, rust-red curves — so the systems you fly through look distinct and art-directed. Appearance only.

Notes: by Babscoole, v6.42, updated 2026-05-29. Eight palettes are mutually exclusive: install exactly one folder.

Wave 2: The Astral Architect

Wave 2: Strategy

The Story So Far

The Astral Architect. The routes you charted have become a civilization. Your freighter commands a fleet; your settlements answer to your name; the threads of pale fire no longer lead you — they follow your designs. You have stopped asking where the light goes and started asking what you will build where it lands. Wave 2 is the capstone: the hardest new game, the richest mod set, and the systems that turn a lone traveler into the architect of a small corner of the galaxy.

This wave is a **new game** on the hardest intended difficulty, with the deepest systems enabled. Everything from Waves 0 and 1 is assumed knowledge.

Settlements & Civilization

1. **Settlements** — the settlement system puts you in charge of a living community: construction decisions, production, and the standing you earn with it. Wave 2 treats the settlement as a real system to run, not a decoration.
2. **Base networks** — multiple bases linked by teleporters, each with a purpose: a mining base, a farm base, a refinery base. The architect's game is logistics across locations.
3. **The endgame loops** — when the story lines run out, the loops that remain are the ones you build: production chains, fleet operations, settlement growth, and the hunt for perfection (S-class everything, maxed tech).

The Capstone Fleet

1. **Freighter as command ship** — your freighter is the hub of the endgame: fleet management, storage, base-building in space.
2. **Fleet composition** — specialized frigate squadrons (combat, trade, exploration, industrial, support) assigned to the right missions. The endgame fleet is a logistics puzzle, and Wave 2 mods may deepen exactly that puzzle.
3. **Upgrade the fleet** — freighter tech, frigate class upgrades, and the long grind to a perfect fleet. The grind is the game; a mod that skips it fails the wave.

Deep Systems & Emergent Play

Wave 2's mods compose: mechanics mods from this wave sit on top of Wave 1's content and Wave 0's base, and they must **compose** — each new system should interact with the others, creating decisions that did not exist in vanilla.

1. **Production depth** — refining, extraction, and manufacturing chains with real choices about what to build where.
2. **Exploration depth** — reasons to go to specific planets, hunt specific resources, chase specific rewards.
3. **Progression depth** — endgame progression that costs effort and opens options, not shortcuts.

Tip: The test for any Wave 2 mod: **does it create a decision I did not have yesterday?** If the answer is yes, it belongs. If the answer is “it makes the number go up,” it does not.

The Hardest New Game

1. Start a new game on **Permadeath** (or Survival with self-imposed rules — no reloading from cloud saves).
2. Enable Wave 0's base and Wave 1 + Wave 2's content/mechanics mods together.
3. Set yourself a capstone goal: a maxed settlement, a perfect fleet, a production empire — one project to architect.

4. Play the endgame loops deliberately, and document what you build in your cartographer's notes.

Warning: Permadeath plus mods is the honest endgame: any mod that touches survival numbers changes the stakes of the whole run. Check each Wave 2 card's Impact field before enabling it on a Permadeath save.

Wave 2: Modlist

Wave 2 is the richest layer: the deepest mechanics, the most content, the fullest expression of the modlist philosophy. The rule from Wave 1 holds and sharpens — new systems and new decisions yes, pure power spikes never. At this wave, mods must also **compose**: a Wave 2 mechanic should interact with Wave 1's systems and Wave 0's base rather than stand apart.

As of 2026-08-12 the maintained No Man's Sky modding scene is thin at this depth: fleet, settlement, and endgame-system mods are almost all abandoned (last updated before the 2025 modding rework) or pure power spikes, so most cards below remain **"user to provide"** rather than being padded with incompatible or unearned mods. The evaluated and rejected candidates are recorded in STATUS.md. The cards that are filled were verified on Nexus on 2026-08-12 and carry their last-updated dates for the compatibility heuristic.

Mechanics

The deepest systems: endgame production, fleet and settlement depth, progression that costs real effort.

Note: Open slots: no maintained mod was found for endgame production, settlement management, or endgame progression that fits the wave rules. Evaluated-and-rejected candidates are listed in STATUS.md; the Fleet & Freighter slot is filled in the Mechanics chapter below.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Content

The capstone content: new activities and systems that compose with everything before them.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Wave 2: Mechanics

The endgame systems, and where the deepest mechanics mods belong.

Production & Manufacturing

The endgame economy is built: extraction networks, refining chains, manufacturing. Mechanics mods here add production depth — new chains, new machines, real routing decisions. The bar: a mod must make you choose what to build and where, not simply print more of what you already have.

Note: This slot is open: as of 2026-08-12 no maintained mod was found that deepens production without changing rates (Beyond Base Building's optional rate multipliers are a power spike and are intentionally left off in this modlist). See STATUS.md.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Fleet & Freighter Depth

The fleet as a logistics puzzle: frigate specialization, mission planning, freighter operations. Mods that deepen fleet decisions fit here; mods that inflate fleet power do not.

Better Frigate View

Dependencies: None

Impact: Pulls the frigate inspection camera back so the whole ship and its perk list fit on screen, and improves the frigate view from the freighter command panel. A readability fix for the fleet screens you live in at this wave — no stats touched.

Notes: by Lo2k, v2.3, updated 2025-09-06 (game 6.03).

Settlement Systems

Running a settlement is running a small economy: construction, production, standing. Mechanics mods may deepen the settlement loop with real decisions.

Note: This slot is open: no maintained settlement mod exists for modern game builds (the few on Nexus date from 2018–2023 and predate the modding rework). See STATUS.md.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Endgame Progression

The long chase — S-class everything, maxed tech, perfect loadouts. Mods may add new endgame progression paths that cost effort and open options.

Note: This slot is open: the maintained mods that touch endgame either remove the hunt (all-S-class generation — a pure power spike) or are abandoned. See STATUS.md for the evaluated list.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Wave 2: Content

The capstone content layer. Wave 2 content mods must do three things at once: add something new to do, interact with the systems already in play, and never hand out raw power. The richest mods are the ones that turn two existing systems into a third — a production chain that feeds a settlement, a fleet loop that funds an exploration hunt.

Note: This slot is open: as of 2026-08-12 no maintained capstone-content mod was found that composes with Wave 1's systems without handing out power. The evaluated-and-rejected list is in STATUS.md.

user to provide

Dependencies: user to provide

Impact: user to provide

Notes: user to provide

Wave 2: Graphics

The capstone deserves the cleanest cockpit. Graphics mods at this wave polish the interfaces you now live in — fleet screens, settlement management, production views — and the worlds you architect. Appearance only, as always.

Better Asteroid Explosions

Dependencies: None

Impact: Reworks asteroid destruction: proper debris scattering, chunkier explosions with distinct effects for special and large asteroids, and less camera shake when you hit small rocks. Space combat and mining look and feel cleaner — no damage changes.

Notes: by Lo2k, v3.6, updated 2025-03-04; the page notes v3.6 was rewritten to avoid conflicts with other Lo2k mods.

Glossary

Currencies & Progression

1. **Units** — the everyday currency of No Man's Sky. Earned by selling resources, discoveries, and missions; spent on ships, supplies, and upgrades.
2. **Nanites** — the upgrade currency. Earned by uploading scanned discoveries, completing missions, and some NPC interactions; spent on technology and upgrade modules.
3. **Quicksilver** — the Anomaly's special currency. Earned from Nexus missions and expeditions; spent on cosmetic and exotic items.
4. **Ship classes** — C, B, A, and S. Class determines a ship's stat potential; S-class is the rarest and best. The class hunt is a core endgame loop.
5. **Drop pod** — a planetary shelter that grants a free exosuit inventory slot. One of the main ways to expand your carry capacity.

Equipment

1. **Exosuit** — your body: inventory, tech slots, life support, hazard protection. Upgrading it is the highest-value investment in the game.
2. **Multi-tool** — your tool and weapon: mining beam, scanner, and weapons in one package. Classes and types vary (pistol, rifle, experimental, alien).
3. **Starship** — your personal ship, used for atmospheric and space flight. Classes and types vary; the launch thruster and pulse engine are its baseline systems.
4. **Freighter** — the large capital ship that acts as a mobile base: storage, fleet management, and warp-capable home.
5. **Frigate** — smaller support ships you buy and send on missions from your freighter. Specializations include combat, trade, exploration, industrial, and support.
6. **Exocraft** — ground vehicles (and more) unlocked through base-building quests. Each type serves a different planet-side role.

Survival Systems

1. **Life support** — the suit's oxygen-fed life meter. Drains constantly; refilled with oxygen. Empty life support drains health.
2. **Hazard protection** — shields against a planet's hazards (heat, cold, radiation, toxicity). Refilled with sodium; on extreme worlds it depletes fast.
3. **Sentinels** — the galaxy's automated police. They react to mined resources and misbehavior; their wanted level escalates.
4. **Saving** — exiting your ship, save points, and save beacons save the game. No Man's Sky does not autosave on a timer.

Flight & Travel

1. **Launch thrusters** — the takeoff system. Needs Launch Fuel (Di-hydrogen + Metal Plating) to leave a planet.
2. **Pulse engine** — the in-system drive for fast travel between planets and within a star system.
3. **Hyperdrive** — the between-systems drive. Requires Warp Cells (Antimatter + Antimatter Housing) to travel to other star systems.
4. **Star system** — a sun and its planets; each system has an economy type and wealth level, and belongs to a faction.
5. **Galaxy map** — the navigation view of all star systems. With the economy scanner, it shows each system's economy and wealth.

6. **Space station** — the orbital hub of a star system: trade terminal, upgrade vendors, teleporter, and missions.
7. **Teleporter** — instant travel between space stations and your bases' teleporters. The fast-travel network.

Story & Hubs

1. **Awakenings** — the tutorial quest line that takes you from the wrecked ship to your first space station.
2. **The Atlas Path** — the philosophical main line about the universe's creators; rewards blueprints and lore.
3. **The Artemis Path** — the long-form story campaign that unlocks after your first few hyperdrive jumps.
4. **The Anomaly** — the multiplayer hub you can summon in space: the Nexus mission board, quicksilver shop, and base-building specialists.
5. **Nexus** — the mission board inside the Anomaly. Source of quicksilver and multiplayer missions.
6. **Settlement** — a community you take charge of: construction, production, and standing decisions.
7. **Expedition** — a limited-time structured campaign with its own save slot, goals, and rewards. (In-game content; not to be confused with frigate missions.)

Base Building & Economy

1. **Base computer** — the device that claims a plot of land as your base.
2. **Refiner** — turns raw resources into better ones (carbon → condensed carbon, ferrite → pure ferrite).
3. **Extractor** — harvests mineral or gas deposits continuously for automation.
4. **Trade route** — buying goods in systems where they are cheap and selling where they are scarce.
5. **Economy scanner** — a ship technology that reveals a system's economy type and wealth on the galaxy map.
6. **Portal** — a late-game structure that teleports you to specific planets via glyph addresses.